SAP Business Network for Logistics- Best Practice

This site is dedicated to collecting all best practices for SAP Business Network for Logistics.

Pre-Implementation

- Think about the solution as a whole rather than focusing on BN4L only. A back-end system (e.g. TM, S/4Hana, EWM, YL etc.) is a leading system that determines how various logistics processes, data flow and collaboration with trading partners via BN4L will look like. Build all these scenarios coming from the back-end system into the BN4L and not vice versa.
- Review Activate Road Map Viewer to get familiar with SAP Activate phases that provide clear guidance at every step of the implementation journey.
- Consider customer's existing and future processes in their back-end system as well as back-end limitations and compatibility with BN4L. Review Tips and Tricks blog and this document with best practices prior the implementation.
- Telling the narrative from BN4L point of view quite often doesn't reflect the reality of projects where BN4L is implemented as it doesn't reflect needs and scenarios of customer's back-end.
- Supply Chain Logistics Maturity Model introduces a structured framework developed by SAP to help logistics leaders assess and improve their supply chain operations. This resource can be leveraged by our customers ahead of their IT transformation initiatives to assess their current maturity level and define strategic next steps.

Shipper Onboarding

Shipper onboarding includes initial configuration of global BTP account which includes subaccounts creation and subscription to applications for BN4L, user management or establishing trust between subaccounts and Identity Authentication tenant.

Material Name	Content Location	Brief Description	Scope	Classification
Onboarding Resource Center	SAP Support	Access to webinars and BN4L Community website, explanation of tenant provisioning process, S-user support documentation,	FC, GTT	External

		deployment descriptions, FAQ, tips and tricks for change management		
Provisioning	Digital Library	Explanation of BN4L provisioning steps and access to related documentation	FC, GTT	External
Administration guide for shippers	Official product documentation	Administration guide describes the steps shipper needs to perform as an administrator to set up the system and to set up the connection to BN4L FC.	FC	External
Administration guide for solution owners	Official product documentation	Administration guide describes the steps shipper needs to perform as an administrator to set up the system and to set up the connection to BN4L GTT.	GTT	External
Discover Organizational Change Management for SAP Cloud Projects	SAP Learning	How organizational change management can contribute to the success of your SAP cloud project.	Generic Content	External

Solution Implementation

Implementation of the solution includes technical integration between BN4L and client's back-end system, functional configuration, testing and cutover activities. Best practices in this section are broken down into several categories to cover most important areas.

Material Name	Content Location	Brief Description	Scope	Classification
Configuring SAP Business Network for Logistics	SAP Learning	Introduction to the key concepts of SAP Business Network for Logistics implementation process, incl. shipper scenarios, shipper onboarding, connectivity, business configuration, responsibilities to carriers and deployment strategy.	FC, GTT	External
Demo Gems	MS Teams Presales Community	Demo recordings, mainly product feature and extension related	FC, GTT	Internal
Internal Deep Dive Videos (TM+BN4L)	Digital Library	The main purpose of the “deep-dive” video is to provide solution architect with a video that can be used for a demo if a live system is not	FC, GTT, TM	Internal

		available. They are full screen with no zoom, highlighting, annotations, intro or outro. These videos do have audio to understand the demo flow, but the audio can be muted and then presented in the SA's own words. These videos are "internal" in DGL and are intended to be downloaded and presented from a PC in a customer meeting.		
External Deep Dive Videos (TM+BN4L)	Digital Library	A customer version of the "deep-dive" videos. This version has the standard SAP intro and outro and may have zooming and annotation as well. It is intended as a leave-behind following a customer demo. They have closed captions in the 10 major languages and are also available in IRIS.	FC, GTT, TM	External
SAP Business Network Community Hub	Pre-Sales Workzone	Different extension scenarios available that can give an idea on what can be achieved on top of the standard features. Note that these are happy-path extensions to show what could be possible and is not ready to consume / use out of the box.	FC, GTT	Internal
Tips & Tricks with SAP Business Network for Logistics	SAP Community	Common queries/issues/know-hows in Business Network for Logistics and their resolution/explanation.	FC, GTT	External
How to setup direct connection from on prem to BN4L FC	SAP Community	Different connectivity options between On-Premise system (S4 or SAP TM standalone) and BN4L FC	FC	External
Implementation best practices	Official product documentation	Best practices for FC implementation for SI partners	FC	SAP and Partners Only
How to send shipment document to from SAP ERP to BN4L	SAP Community	Information on how to setup shipment integration with BN4L	FC	External
Understanding the freight order collaboration process	SAP Community	Focus on the Freight Order collaboration process on BN4L , important things to know about our SAP terminology, impacts on carrier integration, and more.	FC	External

Common connectivity Issues	SAP Community	Common connectivity errors we see that customers make when trying to connect to/from BN4L using B2B SOAP messages from/to their backend system.	FC	External
SEND_TOR BOPF action is not generating XML to carrier	SAP Notes	What to do when following errors occur: • You have a Freight Order/Freight Booking which has a carrier assigned. • When sending the document to carrier, there is no XML message generated.	FC	Internal
How to configure email notification feature for integration errors	SAP Community	To simplify monitoring by customers and business partners, email notification feature for integration errors can be configured. This document details the steps to configure email notification.	FC	External
Freight Collaboration for RFQ based Tendering Scenario (BroadCasting Tendering)	SAP Community	Detailed configuration process for RFQ based tendering via BN4L FC.	FC	External
Freight contracting process (road)	Official product documentation	Details about freight contracting process via BN4L FC	FC	External
Freight booking process (ocean, air)	Official product documentation	Details about freight booking process via BN4L FC	FC	External
External planning: Understanding External Planning APIs	SAP Community	BN4L FC supports outsourcing the planning process, where the ordering party on Transportation Management (TM) on SAP S/4HANA can create freight units and outsource the planning of freight units to a forwarder. This is done through REST APIs and the flow is described in this blog. More details on each step is also explained in the product help page.	FC	External
External planning process	Official product documentation	Details about outsourced planning flow in BN4L FC and available API's.	FC	External

Dock appointment scheduling: Cookbook for DAS Integration with External Systems	Official product documentation	Integration of dock appointment scheduling functionality in SAP Business Network for Logistics with external systems using APIs	FC	External
Dock Appointment Scheduling: Preferred Timeslots by Shipper	SAP Community	Blog describing 2502 release - BN4L FC-DAS now supports preferred time slots for the Provider API for Dock Appointment Scheduling.	FC	External
Dock Appointment Scheduling: Use Derived Appointment Duration	SAP Community	With this feature shippers can optimize their dock utilization calculating the loading or unloading durations for example in SAP TM and TM in S/4HANA (Transportation Management) and submit the start and end date and time to (SAP BN4L FC-DAS).	FC	External
Dock Appointment Scheduling: Maximum Capacity Blocker	SAP Community	Dock Appointment Scheduling now allows users to block an entire Loading Point's capacity, including the overbooking limit, for specific periods across all shared docking locations.	FC	External
Settlement: Understanding the settlement process	SAP Community	Some of the common scenarios to understand the document status and the action that is required to procced.	FC	External
Settlement process	Official product documentation	Details about freight settlement process via BN4L FC	FC	External
New SOAP Services for integration of Invoice Status Update with SAP Business Network for Logistics	SAP Community	Steps to activate new SOAP Services for integration of Invoice Status Update with SAP Business Network for Logistics.	FC	External
Generic test plan for Freight Collaboration	CoE SharePoint	List of recommended test transactions for FC. Note: All customers have to adjust it per their business transactions and requirements.	FC	External
What is SBN GTT and why do I keep hearing	SAP Community	Answers what SBN GTT is, including link to a demo.	GTT	External

about logistics visibility? See the new Product Tour				
Implementation best practices	Official product documentation	Best practices for GTT implementation for SI partners	GTT	SAP and Partners Only
Why logistics visibility is best with BN4L GTT	SAP Community	(high level) Seven distinct benefits of BN4L GTT that goes over and above an individual visibility platform or service.	GTT	External
Why choose SAP Business Network Global Track and Trace over individual visibility platforms (1 of 7)	SAP Community	(detailed) Seven distinct benefits of BN4L GTT that goes over and above an individual visibility platform or service.	GTT	External
How to add customizing field for GTT sample extractor code?	SAP Community	How to adjust the Template Extractors in case you customer is using SAP TM standalone or ECC.	GTT	External
Adding custom events in Business Network for Logistics - Global Track and Trace(GTT)	SAP Community	How to track non-standard internal or external events that are specific to customer's industry or driven by internal KPIs to monitor the status of business documents.	GTT	External
Harmonizing tracking across SAP Business Network for Logistics	SAP Community	This article outlines the new, harmonized tracking experience (as a result of 2511 release) and the role of the shared Web UI for manual event reporting—the 'Manage Freight Execution' app —which provides a consistent look for role-appropriate views by shippers and carriers, and ties events to a central tracking table accessible from both FC and GTT.	FC, GTT	External
Configurations in SAP S/4HANA for Fulfillment Tracking Apps | SAP Help Portal	Official product documentation	General Template Extractors which are meant for customers with S/4 in place.	GTT	External
How to extract carrier notes as Tracked Objects for GTT shipment	SAP Community	How to extract carrier related information from SAP TM which are important for tracking initialization towards Carriers / visiblity providers	GTT	External

		(like mobile phone number, license plate etc.).		
Frequently used APPs in BN4L GTT and its user manual and FAQs	SAP Community	Brief introduction of the frequently used GTT apps as well as user manual and related FAQ.	GTT	External
Setting up connection between SAP S/4HANA and BN4L GTT	SAP Community	Step by step guide to setup connection between SAP S/4HANA and GTT which is necessary for location replication. This blog does not cover the Shipment integration between GTT and S4 which is done via IDOCs.	GTT	External
Setting up connection between SAP S/4HANA (on-prem) and BN4L GTT	SAP Community	Focus on replicating transactional data to use the fulfilment tracking apps.	GTT	External
How to Send Documents from SAP S/4HANA to BN4L GTT	Official product documentation	Shipment integration between GTT and S/4HANA via IDOCs	GTT	External
How to Integrate SAP ECC/SAP TM (standalone) With BN4L GTT	SAP Community	Possible solutions on how to integrate BN4L GTT with SAP ECC or SAP TM (standalone) or S/4HANA or S/4HANA (TM).	GTT	External
Common integration issues	SAP Community	Captures various integration flows, tools available within the application, and the common connectivity errors that a customer can face when integrating with BNL GTT.	GTT	External
How to replicate location from SAP ERP to BN4L	SAP Community	For BN4L GTT, the location master data from S/4 can synchronized out of the box since the location object is unified and extraction of location data via web service in already delivered. However, in SAP ERP it is not case. If you still have a need to replicate location in SAP ERP, use information in this blog.	GTT	External
Send shipment status to customer/buyer using easy rules	SAP Community	Introduction of a new feature where business user can define rules for notification with an intuitive app with zero coding. GTT now provides public URL by which anyone can access basic tracking information without logging to GTT with a user (the way you access FedEx or UPS	GTT	External

		tracking link without having a user in their website)		
Location replication from one SAP S/4HANA system to multiple BN4L tenants using decentralized integration scenarios in SOAMANAGER	SAP Community	The steps mentioned in this blog are using decentralized configuration (local configuration) approach in SOAMANAGER.	FC, GTT	External
Location replication from one SAP S/4HANA system to multiple BN4L tenants using centralized integration scenarios in SOAMANAGER	SAP Community	This blog is a continuation of a previous blog where we talked about achieving the same configurations using de-centralized (local) configuration in SOAMANAGER. If the central configurations are enabled in your SOAMANAGER, you should be following this blog to achieve the desired result.	FC, GTT	External

Network Partners

There are two types of network partners that SAP collaborate with within BN4L solution.

Tracking Collaboration

- Integrate with SAP Business Network for Logistics (BN4L) for event reporting purpose.
- LSPs / carriers onboarded to this type of network partners are able to share tracking information and report events to customers through BN4L.
- Visibility service providers / visibility data aggregators

Transacting Collaboration

- Integrate with SAP Business Network for Logistics (BN4L) for transacting purpose.
- LSPs / carriers onboarded to this type of network partners are able to transact business documents through BN4L, e.g. Request for Quotation, Freight orders, invoices etc.

Why choose SAP Business Network Global Track and Trace over individual visibility platforms

project44 (visibility provider)

project44 is a visibility provider that provides real-time tracking capabilities and is offered together with BN4L GTT. This section includes best practices, requirements and recommendations to set up a project for a

success.

Material Name	Content Location	Brief Description	Scope	Classification
RACI for SAP+p44 projects	Knowledge@Ariba	Explanation of key project milestones and involved parties for the implementation of BN4L with project44 as visibility provider.	GTT, FC, project44	Internal
Feature scope description	Official product documentation	Explanation of project44 add-ons for BN4L and details about real-time visibility content services that are available for FC and GTT.	GTT, FC, project44	External
p44 add-on solution offering	Official product documentation	Joint solution offering and details on how to leverage p44 add-ons for customer projects.	GTT, FC, project44	External
GTT with project44 end-to-end task list	Digital Library	Compilation of various resources available on help.sap.com. This document provides a comprehensive view of the steps necessary when deploying project44 as a visibility provider.	GTT, project44	Internal
Configuration and application guide	Official product documentation	Explanation of required organizational and configuration steps for the consumption of project44 services through BN4L FC as well as GTT.	GTT, project44	External
Mapping activities	Knowledge@Ariba	High level overview of all mapping and configuration activities related to carrier onboarding at SAP Business Network for Logistics in both test and production environment.	FC, GTT, project44	SAP and Partners Only
Legal and data security	CoE SharePoint	Documents that describe how p44 protects customer and carrier data.	project44	Internal
Mode-specific supportive material	CoE SharePoint	Additional knowledge material to better understand p44 mode-specific requirements	project44	Internal
p44 carrier outreach service	Knowledge@Ariba	Explanation of p44 carrier outreach process.	project44	External

Supported languages	CoE SharePoint	Available languages for p44 carrier onboarding support for each mode of transport.	project44	Internal
Supported countries	CoE SharePoint	Geographical coverage per mode of transport.	project44	Internal
Carrier onboarding kick off and deep dive templates	CoE SharePoint	Customer facing kick off and deep dive templates.	project44	Internal
Communication templates	CoE SharePoint	Project Notification Letters and Go Live Letter templates that customer can modify and send to carriers to level set the expectations.	project44	Internal
Network Management Center (NMC) registration guide for new carriers	project44 support page	Detailed step-by-step guide that explains carrier registration process in NMC.	project44	External

FourKites (visibility provider)

FourKites is a global supply chain intelligence platform that provides real-time visibility and execution for over 1200 companies and third-party logistics firms across 200 nations.

Material Name	Content Location	Brief Description	Scope	Classification
Official website of FourKites	Official website	Official website.	GTT, FourKites	External
Product description	SAP Store	Introduction of the product, including video, supported features, pricing and technical information.	GTT, FourKites	External

Shippeo (visibility provider)

Shippeo is a global leader in real-time multimodal transportation visibility, empowering major shippers and logistics providers for resilient, sustainable, and customer-centric supply chains. SAP partners with Shippeo to offer real-time shipment tracking capabilities for various modes of transport within SAP Business Network for Logistics solution.